

IT Helpdesk Outsourcing - Manufacturing

How a large manufacturing firm can free its internal IT team for strategic projects.

Introduction

A large manufacturing firm is spending nearly 70% of its internal IT team's time on routine L1 and L2 tickets. As a result, strategic projects like ERP upgrades and factory digitization are getting delayed because the team does not have enough bandwidth.

Background

Manufacturing companies rely on IT not only for office systems but also for production support, shop-floor connectivity, and enterprise applications. When the internal team spends most of its time on repetitive helpdesk work, it has less capacity for transformation and business-critical improvements.

Support Delivery Model

- **Outsource L1 Support** - Routine password resets, access issues, and basic troubleshooting should be handled by an external helpdesk partner.
- **Keep L2/L3 Internal** - Complex incidents, plant-critical systems, and architecture decisions should remain with the internal team.
- **Self-Service Portal** - A portal and knowledge base can solve many repetitive issues without human intervention.
- **Standard Ticket Routing** - Tickets should be classified clearly so that each issue goes to the right support level quickly.
- **SLA-Based Governance** - The vendor should be managed through service-level agreements, escalation rules, and monthly reviews.

Operating Improvements

The firm should identify the most common tickets, automate repeat tasks, and document solutions in a shared knowledge base. It should also define which systems are business-critical so that factory operations are never exposed to poor issue handling or slow escalation.

Impact

This model can reduce the workload on the internal IT team, improve ticket resolution efficiency, and allow faster progress on ERP and digital transformation projects. It also improves scalability because the outsourcing layer can absorb high volumes of routine requests while internal staff focus on strategic work.

Final Note

The best approach is not full outsourcing, but a hybrid model that keeps strategic control inside while shifting repetitive work outside. That balance helps the manufacturing firm protect operations, improve support quality, and free its internal team for transformation work.

Questions for Discussion

- Why should only L1 support be outsourced in this model?
- How does a self-service portal reduce helpdesk load?
- What should remain under internal IT control in a manufacturing setup?
- How can SLAs protect support quality after outsourcing?